



What You Can Sell on SoftStore.pk

A guide for marketplace sellers — what is welcome, what needs approval, what it costs, and how Cash on Delivery changes the answer.

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Pre-launch draft · rules marked VERIFY WITH COUNSEL need legal sign-off

Before you start

SoftStore.pk is an **online marketplace**. You list your products, buyers find them, they order, and you get paid — the same shape as any marketplace you already know. Everything in this document applies to selling here.

There is also an optional programme called **Fulfilled by SoftStore (FBA)**, where we hold your stock and ship it for you. **That is a separate thing you choose, with its own terms and its own fees.** It is described at the end of this document. If you do nothing about it, you are a normal marketplace seller and none of it applies to you.

Two ways to sell

	MARKETPLACE SELLING — THE DEFAULT	FULFILLED BY SOFTSTORE — OPTIONAL
Where your stock lives	Your own shop or godown	A SoftStore fulfilment centre
Who packs each order	You do	We do
Who hands it to the courier	You do, at your own door	We do
What you pay	Commission on delivered orders only	Commission plus fulfilment and storage fees
Available now?	Yes	Not yet — enrolment is still being built
Do you have to do anything?	No. This is how you sell by default.	Yes — you opt in, per product

Unless you deliberately enrol a product into FBA, **you are selling the normal way**: your stock, your packing, your control.

Three things worth knowing up front

- **Almost every order is Cash on Delivery.** The buyer pays at the door. That shapes what sells well and what is risky — see section 4. It applies to both ways of selling.
- **Commission is deducted only when an order is delivered.** Never on the day it is placed, and never on a parcel the buyer refuses.
- **We are new.** At the time of writing no seller has completed a real trade on this platform. What follows describes what the system is built to carry and what our rules are — not a thriving catalogue you are joining. In most categories you would be among the very first genuine listings.

We are not lawyers and this is not legal advice. Where a rule touches Pakistani regulation we have marked it **VERIFY WITH COUNSEL** and kept it general on purpose. Treat those as *"get proper advice"*, not as something to rely on.

What you need before you can list

REQUIREMENT	DETAIL
A registered seller account	Free to create.
A Professional plan or above	Marketplace selling is plan-gated. On a Starter or Basic plan the "show on marketplace" switch is refused outright. Check your plan before you prepare stock.
A product name and a selling price	These are the only two fields the system actually requires. Everything else has a default.
One product image	JPEG, PNG or WebP. Up to 5 MB. One image per product.
Your own sourcing records	Not uploaded anywhere, but you must be able to produce invoices or distributor documents if a buyer disputes authenticity.

The system will let you save a product with almost nothing filled in. Do not take that as permission to list badly — a thin listing is the single biggest cause of a refused parcel, and a refused parcel costs you the round trip.

1. What you can sell

These categories suit this platform and this market. If you run a shop and are wondering whether your stock belongs online, start here.

CATEGORY	WHY IT WORKS ON CASH ON DELIVERY
General retail and kiriyana basics — rice, atta, oil, daily household items	Low price, habitual buying. The customer already knows what it costs, so they rarely refuse at the door.
Groceries and FMCG — packaged food, snacks, toiletries	Frequent, repeat, low-ticket. Buyers reorder the same items, which keeps refusal low.
Fashion and footwear	The biggest online category by volume in Pakistan. It does carry real refusal risk from sizing and fit — see section 4 — but demand is strong enough to be worth carrying if you manage that.
Mobile accessories — cases, chargers, cables, screen protectors	Cheap, impulse-buy, easy to describe accurately. Low value means a refusal barely stings.
Home and kitchen — crockery, storage, small décor	Steady, mid-trust. Buyers are forgiving of small variation, so disputes stay low.
Beauty tools and accessories — brushes, mirrors, hair accessories	Popular, low value, non-medicinal. Actual cosmetics and skincare fall under section 2, not here.
Stationery and office supplies	Reliable, low value, seasonal spikes at school reopening. One of the safest COD categories there is.

Categories the platform already supports

The system currently carries **37 distinct category names** across groceries, fashion, electronics, home goods, beauty and stationery, with listings spanning **PKR 50 to PKR 186,855**. Categories are per-shop, not a fixed platform list — you name your own, and if you leave it blank the system will attempt to match one from your product name.

Nine categories currently hold one product or fewer, including Books, Art Supplies, Cleaning, Fresh Produce, Mobile Accessories and Household Cleaning. If you sell in one of these, you would have that shelf largely to yourself.

2. What needs approval before listing

These are legal to sell, but we ask you to show us something before the listing goes live. This is not paperwork for its own sake — these are exactly the categories that turn into refused parcels, angry buyers, or reputation damage that spreads to every seller on the platform.

CATEGORY	WHAT YOU MUST BE ABLE TO SHOW US	WHY WE ASK
Mobile phones and tablets	Proof the device is compliant and registered for use on Pakistani mobile networks. VERIFY WITH COUNSEL	A phone that stops working on local networks after purchase is a guaranteed return and a furious buyer. Better caught before it ships.
Health and nutrition — vitamins, supplements, protein, herbal items	Manufacturer or import documentation. VERIFY WITH COUNSEL	These go into people's bodies. Buyers trust your listing; we need to be able to trust it too.
Cosmetics and skincare — creams, serums, whitening or treatment products	Ingredient list plus manufacturer or import documentation. VERIFY WITH COUNSEL	Skin reactions and "this is not what was advertised" are the fastest ways an entire category gets a bad name.
Food with an expiry date	Batch and expiry printed on the packaging, with enough shelf life left to survive dispatch and a possible return trip.	An expired item reaching a buyer is a safety complaint, not a returns complaint. A different and worse problem.
Electrical and electronic goods	Basic safety and compliance documentation. VERIFY WITH COUNSEL	A fault in an item that has already travelled through a courier network becomes a liability question for everyone who touched the box.
Gold, silver and jewellery	Proof of purity — hallmark or supplier documentation — plus your own purchase trail. VERIFY WITH COUNSEL	High value plus Cash on Delivery is the hardest combination on this platform. We need to know exactly what is in the box.
Anything sold with a warranty	The warranty terms in writing, and who honours them — you, a distributor, or the brand.	A buyer chasing a warranty with nowhere to send it becomes our problem by default.

3. What you cannot sell

Prohibited outright. No approval process gets you around this list.

PROHIBITED	NOTE
Weapons, ammunition and weapon parts	—
Narcotics and controlled substances	—
Counterfeit or replica branded goods	"First copy" and "master copy" included. Asal maal only — you should be able to produce a receipt trail if asked. VERIFY WITH COUNSEL
Stolen goods	—
Prescription-only medicines	VERIFY WITH COUNSEL
Tobacco and vaping products to minors	Whether these lines are carried at all is still undecided — a COD handover has no reliable way to check age at the door. VERIFY WITH COUNSEL
Adult content	—
Live animals	—
Hazardous or flammable chemicals	Includes anything that cannot legally travel in a standard courier van.
Currency, cheques and financial instruments	VERIFY WITH COUNSEL
Human remains or organs	—
Anything infringing copyright or trademark	VERIFY WITH COUNSEL

4. Cash on Delivery changes what makes sense

Between **15% and 25%** of COD parcels are refused at the door. That is the normal range for this market, not a sign anything is broken. Above roughly 25% it usually means something about your listing, your packaging, or the product itself.

A refused parcel costs you no commission — commission only applies to delivered orders — but the round trip has a real cost, and some product types make that trip far more likely, or far more painful when it happens.

RISK	WHY COD MAKES IT WORSE	WHAT YOU CAN DO
Very high value — large appliances, high-end electronics, big jewellery	Nothing stops a buyer ordering on a whim and refusing at the door. No payment was ever committed.	Keep high-value listings realistic for COD, call to confirm before dispatch, and price the refusal risk in.
Perishable or short shelf-life	If refused or delayed, it cannot be resold and may not be safe to redeliver.	Not recommended on our current logistics. See open questions.
Made-to-order or customised	If the buyer refuses, nobody else wants a one-off. The loss is total, not partial.	Get firm confirmation before you start production. We are COD-only at launch, so there is currently no way to take a deposit.
Fragile — glass, ceramics, screens	Damage risk twice: on the way out, and again on any return leg.	Pack to survive being dropped and stacked. Declare weight and contents accurately so it is not handled wrong.

5. What it costs

Commission is charged **only on delivered marketplace orders**, never on POS sales, and is reversed if a parcel comes back.

CATEGORY	COMMISSION
Mobile phones	1.50%
Laptops and computers	2.50%
Fresh produce and fruits	2.00%
Skincare, makeup	8.00%
Clothing, fashion, kurta, unstitched	10.00%
Footwear	10.00%
Home décor	10.00%
Everything else	5.00% platform default

Rates are seeded at the floor of each published band, never a guessed midpoint. If your category is not listed above, you pay the 5% default.

6. Listing a product

FIELD	REQUIRED?	WHAT HAPPENS IF YOU LEAVE IT
Product name	Yes	Cannot save.
Selling price	Yes	Cannot save. Must be numeric.
SKU	No	Auto-generated. Rejected only if it collides with one of your own.
Barcode	No	Auto-generated. Rejected only on duplicate.
Category	No	The system guesses from your product name, and falls back to a "General Store Items" category. Set it yourself — the guess is often wrong.
Cost price	No	Silently saved as zero. Set it anyway: your profit reports are meaningless without it, and it will block FBA enrolment later.
Description	No	Blank. A blank description is a refused parcel waiting to happen.
Stock quantity	No	Zero.

Images. One per product. JPEG, PNG or WebP, up to 5 MB. The file is checked by reading its actual content, not by trusting the extension, so renaming a `.txt` to `.jpg` will not work. Images are stored outside the public web root and served through a controlled path.

7. Packing and handover

This section is about normal marketplace selling — your stock, packed by you. (If a product is ever enrolled in FBA, we do all of this instead; see section 9.)

You pack each order yourself and hand it over. What you do before the handover decides whether the order goes smoothly.

- **Seal it properly.** Tape it shut, tamper-evident if you can. Once it leaves your hands, the seal is the only proof it left intact.
 - **Label it exactly as given.** Keep the barcode flat and fully visible. Do not tape over it or fold it. A scanner that cannot read the code stalls your parcel.
 - **Declare weight and size honestly.** What you state is what gets booked. A mismatch at pickup can hold up the whole pickup run, not just your parcel.
 - **Be there for the pickup window.** If nobody is there, the parcel does not move and the order slips a day, with a buyer waiting.
 - **Make your shop findable.** A landmark and a phone number that gets answered matter more than a formal address. That is what the rider works from.
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8. When something goes wrong

SITUATION	WHAT HAPPENS	WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOU
Buyer refuses at the door	The courier keeps the box and rides it back on the same consignment. Commission is never charged.	Return shipping may still be deducted from your payout — the rate is not yet fixed, see open questions. High refusal rates show on your dashboard.
Buyer returns after delivery	A reverse consignment is booked to our returns hub. A return leg never collects cash.	Commission is reversed once the return reaches the hub. The item is not automatically returned to sellable stock — it is inspected first.
Damaged or lost in transit	We raise a claim with the courier. Commission is reversed.	You are not chased for a delivery that never arrived intact.
Buyer disputes authenticity	We may pause the listing while we look into it.	Keep your sourcing proof to hand. This is exactly what the section 2 approvals exist to make quick to resolve.

9. Optional — Fulfilled by SoftStore

None of this applies unless you choose it. Everything before this point is how you sell on SoftStore.pk normally. FBA is a separate programme, opted into **per product**, with its own fees and its own terms. You can sell here for years without ever using it.

It is also not open yet. The warehouse system is built, but there is no way for a seller to enrol a product today. It is described here so you can decide whether to prepare for it.

The idea: instead of packing every order yourself, you send stock to a SoftStore fulfilment centre once. After that we store it, pick it, pack it, ship it, handle returns and collect the COD cash. You stop touching parcels for those products.

A product is either normal or FBA — **never both at once**. Products you do not enrol carry on exactly as before, and you can run a mixed shop: some lines fulfilled by us, the rest by you.

When enrolment opens, a product will need a **cost price**, a **declared per-unit weight**, and **length, width and height**. The fulfilment fee is banded by weight:

BAND	WEIGHT	FEE PER ORDER
Small	up to 500 g	PKR 60
Standard	501 g – 2 kg	PKR 90
Large	2 – 5 kg	PKR 150
Bulky	over 5 kg	PKR 280

Plus PKR 100 per inbound shipment and PKR 15 per unit received.

These are placeholder rates, not final pricing. They are seeded so the system always has a rate to charge from. The final card is a business decision that has not been made.

Two things that will not change: **you are charged fulfilment when the parcel is booked, not when it is delivered** — we did the picking and packing either way — and your stock remains **your property** the whole time it is in our building. We hold it; we never own it.

10. Still being decided

Listed honestly rather than answered, so nobody pretends there is a policy where there is not one.

- **1. Tobacco and vaping** — carried at all, given no way to verify age at a doorstep handover?
- **2. Perishable and fresh food** — permitted, given there is no cold-chain handling in our courier operation?
- **3. Made-to-order sellers currently carry 100% of the refusal risk** on production cost, because we are COD-only with no deposit option. Acceptable as-is, or does this category need its own rule?
- **4. Return shipping cost to the seller** — deducted from your statement, but the courier rate card does not exist in our records yet, so we cannot yet tell you the number.
- **5. Return inspection standard** — restocking after a return is a manual judgement today. No written criteria yet for what passes and what is written off.
- **6. Authenticity disputes** — no dedicated escalation flow is built. Section 8 describes a sensible default, not a shipped feature.
- **7. Gold and jewellery verification** — no defined purity check for onboarding these sellers.
- **8. A ceiling on COD order value** — whether very high-value orders should be capped or need extra verification before dispatch.